

Implementation Pro — Go-To-Market

Version: 1.0

Last Updated: 2026-04-02

Owner: John Swapp

Status: Active — Living Document

AI agents that run implementations. You run the show.

Implementation Pro

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1. Strategic Context

The Pivot

Implementation Pro is a full SaaS platform — mobile-first, Stripe-billed. Gumroad is dropped entirely. The prior digital product model (17-template SaaS Implementation Playbook Kit on Gumroad at \$12/mo) served as market validation. The insights from that product — what buyers need, what templates get used, what questions come up — inform the SaaS, but the distribution and billing model is completely new.

What We're Selling

An AI-powered implementation management platform that replaces the spreadsheets, docs, and email chains that SaaS implementation teams cobble together today. AI agents handle the repetitive work (docs, comms, testing, analysis). Humans oversee outcomes.

Category Creation

This is not entering the project management market. Implementation Pro creates a new category: Implementation Management. The distinction matters because implementation teams have domain-specific needs (scope governance via MoSCoW, RACI matrices, go-live checklists, stakeholder communication plans, risk signal detection) that PM tools don't address.

2. Ideal Customer Profile (ICP)

Primary ICP: B2B SaaS Companies with In-House Implementation Teams

Company Profile:

- B2B SaaS company, 50-500 employees
- Sells software that requires professional services for deployment (not self-serve)
- Has a dedicated implementation or professional services team (5-50 people)
- Runs 10-100+ concurrent customer engagements
- Currently uses general PM tools (Jira, Asana, Monday) + spreadsheets + email for implementation work

Pain indicators:

- Implementation team growing but process not scaling with it
- Scope creep is a recurring revenue leak
- Customer handoff from implementation to CS is messy
- Status reporting takes hours per week per consultant
- New hires take months to ramp because playbooks live in people's heads

Buying triggers:

- Hired a new PS Director who wants process discipline
- Lost a key consultant and realized tribal knowledge walked out
- Customer escalation traced back to scope creep nobody tracked
- Board or leadership asking for PS margins and utilization metrics

Secondary ICP: Implementation Consultancies / System Integrators

- Independent firms that implement SaaS products for their clients
- 5-30 consultants, managing 20-80 concurrent engagements
- Higher urgency around financial tracking (billable hours, margins) because that's their entire revenue

Anti-ICP (Not Our Customer)

- Single-product SaaS with self-serve onboarding (no implementation needed)
- Enterprise IT shops running waterfall projects (they use ServiceNow, Planview)
- Freelance consultants with 1-2 engagements (Free tier, but not monetizable)

3. Competitive Landscape

Direct Competitors

There are no well-known, established players in the "Implementation Management" category. This is both an opportunity (category creation) and a challenge (market education).

Adjacent / Indirect Competitors

Category	Players	Why They're Not Us
Project Management	Asana, Monday, Jira, Smartsheet	General-purpose. No MoSCoW, no RACI, no go-live checklists, no scope governance, no AI agents for implementation work
Professional Services Automation (PSA)	Kantata (Mavenlink), Certinia (FinancialForce), Planview	Enterprise-priced (\$100-300/user/mo), complex, slow to deploy. Built for PS accounting, not implementation delivery

Category	Players	Why They're Not Us
Customer Onboarding	GUIDEcx, Rocketlane, TaskRay	Closer, but positioned as "customer onboarding" not "implementation management." Less depth on governance, no AI agents for work execution
Implementation Templates	John's Gumroad Playbook Kit, various consultants' template packs	Static files. No workflow, no AI, no team collaboration, no analytics

Positioning Against Adjacents

vs. PM Tools: "Your PM tool tracks tasks. Implementation Pro manages implementations — scope governance, risk detection, AI-generated deliverables, and a process that gets smarter every engagement."

vs. PSA Tools: "PSA tools are \$200/user and take 6 months to deploy. Implementation Pro is \$49/mo and you're running engagements by end of day."

vs. Onboarding Tools: "Onboarding tools focus on customer-facing task tracking. Implementation Pro manages the full implementation lifecycle — operations, governance, and AI-powered work execution — from the consultant's perspective."

4. GTM Motion

Product-Led Growth (PLG) — Primary Motion

- At \$49/mo Pro tier, the price point is firmly in PLG territory. The product sells itself through:
- Free tier as top-of-funnel — individual consultants can use core engagement management at no cost
 - Self-serve sign-up — no sales call required to start using the product
 - In-product upgrade triggers — when a user hits the agent task limit (free tier has none), they see the value of Pro
 - Viral loops — when a consultant invites team members, the team grows into the Team tier

Content-Led Acquisition — Supporting Motion

John's existing build-in-public strategy on LinkedIn, combined with implementation expertise content, drives awareness and top-of-funnel traffic.

Motion Breakdown by Phase

Phase	Months	Motion	Goal
Pre-launch	Now - Launch	Build-in-public (LinkedIn) + Waitlist	500 waitlist signups

Phase	Months	Motion	Goal
Launch	Month 1	Product Hunt + LinkedIn launch + Waitlist conversion	100 free signups, 20 paid
Growth	Months 2-6	Content + PLG + Community	500 free, 100 paid
Scale	Months 7-12	PLG + Partnerships + Outbound for Team/Enterprise	2,000 free, 300 paid

5. Pricing & Packaging

Pricing Tiers (Stripe-Billed)

Tier	Price	What's Included	Target
Free	\$0	Core engagement management: CRUD, scope, stakeholders, RACI, checklists, decisions, lessons learned. 1 org, 3 engagements, no AI agents	Individual consultants exploring
Pro	\$49/mo	Everything in Free + unlimited engagements + 50 AI agent tasks/month + status reports + financial tracking	Solo consultants, small teams (1-3)
Team	\$149/mo	Everything in Pro + 500 agent tasks/month + 10 team members + compliance engine + cross-engagement analytics	Implementation teams (4-15)
Enterprise	Custom	Everything in Team + unlimited agent tasks + unlimited members + SSO + dedicated support + custom agent prompts	Large PS organizations

Pricing Rationale

- Free tier removes friction from adoption. Implementation consultants can start tracking engagements immediately.

- **\$49/mo Pro** is an individual expense threshold — a consultant can expense it without VP approval. This is critical for bottom-up adoption.
- **\$149/mo Team** is justified by the time savings from 500 agent tasks. If each agent task saves 15 minutes of manual work, 500 tasks = 125 hours saved/month — a clear ROI against \$149.
- **Enterprise** captures large organizations where per-seat pricing at scale justifies custom contracts.

Billing Infrastructure

- All billing through Stripe (Checkout, Customer Portal, Webhooks)
- 30-day free trial on all paid tiers
- Monthly billing only at launch; annual billing (with discount) added when retention data is available
- Gumroad is fully deprecated — no new Gumroad sales

6. Gumroad Sunset Plan

Current State

The SaaS Implementation Playbook Kit is live on Gumroad:

- **URL:** swappster4.gumroad.com//playbook-kit
- **Pricing:** \$12/mo or \$79/yr (30-day free trial)
- **Product ID (life-os):** `<font name="Courier" color="#334155">10896661-d90e-4e3b-a354-855f84102ede</font>`

Sunset Approach

Step	Timeline	Action
1. Stop new sales	SaaS launch day	Remove Gumroad product from public listings. Existing subscribers continue.
2. Notify existing subscribers	Launch + 1 week	Email: "We've built something better. Here's your free upgrade to Implementation Pro."
3. Migration incentive	Launch + 1-4 weeks	Existing Gumroad subscribers get 3 months free on Pro tier (via Stripe coupon)
4. Gumroad deactivation	Launch + 90 days	Cancel all remaining Gumroad subscriptions. Final email with migration link.

What Happens to the Templates

The 17 templates from the Playbook Kit are the DNA of Implementation Pro. They're not deleted — they're embedded in the SaaS:

- Kickoff Prep Kit → Onboarding wizard + Checklist tab
- Stakeholder Alignment → Stakeholder tab + RACI tab
- Scope Management → Scope tab (MoSCoW tracker)
- Go-Live Checklist → Checklist tab (go-live type)
- Status Reporting → Reports tab + Communication Agent
- Lessons Learned → Lessons tab
- Handoff Documentation → Documentation Agent artifacts

7. Launch Strategy

Pre-Launch (Now through Launch)

Build-in-Public on LinkedIn:

- Post 2-3 times per week showing the build process
- Content types: dev progress, design decisions, implementation war stories, AI agent demos
- Rules: Never put links in the post body. CTA in comments only. Show the product working, not dashboard screenshots.
- Goal: Build an audience of implementation professionals who are invested in the product before it launches

Waitlist:

- Landing page with waitlist form (already scaffolded: `<font name="Courier" color="#334155">src/components/landing/waitlist-form.tsx</font>`, `<font name="Courier" color="#334155">src/app/api/waitlist/route.ts</font>`)
- Waitlist gets early access before public launch
- Goal: 500 signups

Content SEO (Plant Seeds):

- Write 5-10 blog posts targeting implementation-specific keywords:
- "SaaS implementation checklist"
- "MoSCoW prioritization for implementations"
- "Implementation scope creep management"
- "Implementation handoff documentation template"
- "AI for professional services"
- Publish on personal blog or Medium. Drive traffic to waitlist.
- These become evergreen traffic sources post-launch.

Launch Week

Day 1: Waitlist Conversion

- Email waitlist with early access link

- 30-day free trial on Pro tier

Day 2-3: Product Hunt Launch

- Title: "Implementation Pro — AI agents that run SaaS implementations"
- Category: Productivity / SaaS Tools
- Maker story: solo builder, 10 years of implementation experience, built with AI
- Goal: Top 5 of the day

Day 3-5: LinkedIn Launch

- Launch announcement post (personal story format — not corporate announcement)
- Follow-up posts showing real usage: "Here's how the Documentation Agent just saved me 2 hours on a handoff doc"
- Engage every comment. Reply to every DM.

Day 5-7: Community Distribution

- Post in relevant communities: r/SaaS, r/consulting, implementation-focused Slack groups
- Share the Product Hunt page for upvote momentum

Post-Launch (Months 1-3)

Content cadence: 2 LinkedIn posts/week + 1 blog post/month

User onboarding optimization:

- Track where users drop off in the signup → first engagement → first agent task flow
- A/B test onboarding wizard steps
- Email drip sequence: Day 1 (welcome), Day 3 (create your first engagement), Day 7 (try an AI agent), Day 14 (invite your team)

Feedback loop:

- In-app feedback collection on every AI agent output (accepted/modified/rejected)
- Monthly user interviews (5 per month) with paying customers
- Feature request tracking in ClickUp or Notion

8. Channel Strategy

Tier 1 Channels (Primary — invest heavily)

LinkedIn (organic):

- John's personal profile is the primary distribution channel
- Build-in-public narrative creates parasocial investment in the product
- Implementation expertise content positions John as the category authority
- Direct DM conversations convert followers to trial users

SEO / Content Marketing:

- Target implementation-specific long-tail keywords (low competition, high intent)
- Create the definitive content library for "implementation management"

- Each piece of content has a CTA to the free tier

Product-Led Growth (in-product):

- Free tier is the biggest acquisition channel at scale
- Upgrade prompts at natural friction points (engagement limit, agent task limit)
- Team invites drive organic expansion within organizations

Tier 2 Channels (Supporting — invest moderately)

Product Hunt:

- One-time launch event, but drives sustained traffic via the Product Hunt page
- Potential for "Product of the Day" badge (credibility signal)

Community (Reddit, Slack groups, Discord):

- Participate authentically in implementation / consulting communities
- Answer questions, share expertise, mention the product when genuinely relevant
- Never spam — this is relationship-building, not broadcast

Email (Resend-powered):

- Waitlist nurture sequence
- Post-signup onboarding drip
- Monthly product update newsletter
- Powered by Resend integration already built into the platform

Tier 3 Channels (Future — experiment later)

Partnerships:

- SaaS companies whose customers need implementation support
- Integration partnerships (Slack, HubSpot, Salesforce) that create distribution through marketplace listings
- Consulting firms who could use Implementation Pro as their operating system

Paid Acquisition:

- Not warranted until organic channels are optimized and unit economics are proven
- If tested: LinkedIn Ads targeting "Implementation Manager" and "Professional Services Director" titles

9. Key Metrics & Goals

Acquisition Metrics

Metric	Month 3 Target	Month 6 Target	Month 12 Target
Waitlist signups (pre-launch)	500	—	—
Free tier signups	200	500	2,000

Metric	Month 3 Target	Month 6 Target	Month 12 Target
Paid conversions (Pro + Team)	30	100	300
Website traffic (monthly)	5,000	15,000	50,000

Revenue Metrics

Metric	Month 3 Target	Month 6 Target	Month 12 Target
MRR	\$1,500	\$5,000	\$20,000
ARPU	\$50	\$55	\$65
Trial-to-Paid conversion	10%	15%	18%
Monthly churn	< 8%	< 5%	< 4%

Engagement Metrics

Metric	Target	Why It Matters
Activation (create first engagement within 24 hours)	60%	Users who create an engagement in the first session are 3x more likely to convert
AI agent adoption (at least 1 agent task in first 14 days)	40%	Agent usage is the primary value differentiator — users who try it, stay
Weekly active engagement rate	70% of paid users	Indicates the product is part of the daily workflow, not shelfware
Team invite rate	30% of paid users invite ≥1 teammate	Viral expansion indicator; predictor of upgrade to Team tier

10. Messaging Framework

Core Positioning Statement

For SaaS implementation teams who manage complex customer deployments, Implementation Pro is the first AI-powered platform purpose-built for implementation management. Unlike generic PM tools or expensive PSA suites, Implementation Pro combines scope governance, risk detection, and AI agents that handle the repetitive work — so your team focuses on delivery, not admin.

Value Propositions (by persona)

For the Implementation Consultant:

"Stop spending half your week on status reports and docs. AI agents handle the repeatable work. You handle the relationships."

For the PS Director:

"See risk before it becomes a fire. Track utilization, margins, and compliance across every engagement — without chasing spreadsheets."

For the CS Manager:

"Get a clean handoff every time. Implementation Pro generates the documentation, so nothing falls through the cracks."

Messaging Don'ts

- Don't say "project management" — we are implementation management
- Don't compare to Jira or Asana — different category
- Don't lead with AI — lead with the implementation problem, AI is the how
- Don't use "revolutionary" or "game-changing" — show the value, don't assert it

11. Content Calendar (First 90 Days Post-Launch)

LinkedIn Posts (2x per week)

Week	Post 1	Post 2
1	Launch story: "I built an AI platform for implementation teams. Here's why."	Product demo: Documentation Agent in action
2	Implementation war story (scope creep)	Show: MoSCoW tracker with real data
3	"Why implementation management is not project management"	User testimonial or early feedback
4	AI agent breakdown: what each agent does	Behind-the-scenes: self-learning system
5	Implementation lessons from 10 years of deployments	Show: risk signal detection catching a real issue
6	"The cost of bad handoffs" (pain-point content)	Product update: what shipped this month
7-12	Rotate: war stories, product demos, implementation tips, user stories	Continue 2x/week cadence

Blog Posts (1x per month)

Month	Title	SEO Target
1	"The SaaS Implementation Checklist: Kickoff to Go-Live"	"SaaS implementation checklist"
2	"MoSCoW Prioritization for Implementation Teams: A Practical Guide"	"MoSCoW prioritization implementation"
3	"How AI Is Changing Professional Services Delivery"	"AI professional services"

12. Risk & Mitigation

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Market education needed for new category	High	High	Build-in-public narrative creates understanding over time. Free tier lowers the barrier to try. Content strategy targets specific pain points, not the category name.
Solo founder limits GTM execution bandwidth	High	Medium	Focus on 2-3 channels maximum. Automate where possible (email drip, in-product upgrade prompts). Defer paid acquisition until organic is working.
Low trial-to-paid conversion	Medium	High	Onboarding optimization sprint in Month 2. Ensure "aha moment" (first AI agent task) happens within the trial period.
Competitor enters the category	Low	Medium	First-mover advantage + category ownership through content. Build switching costs through self-learning (the longer you use it, the better it gets for your org).

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Gumroad subscribers don't migrate	Medium	Low	Financial impact is small (\$12/mo × subscriber count). Migration incentive (3 months free Pro) plus direct email outreach.

13. Budget Constraints

The GTM runs on free and near-free infrastructure:

Item	Cost	Notes
Vercel hosting	Free tier → ~\$20/mo	Hobby tier sufficient for early traffic
Supabase	Free tier → ~\$25/mo	Pro tier at ~500 users
Anthropic API	Variable	~\$0.10-0.50 per agent task depending on complexity
Stripe	2.9% + \$0.30 per transaction	Standard pricing
Resend	Free tier (100 emails/day)	Sufficient for launch
Domain	~\$12/year	implementationpro.com (if available)
Product Hunt	Free	One-time launch
LinkedIn	Free (organic only)	No paid ads at launch
Total fixed monthly	~\$50-75/mo	Scales with usage, not upfront

14. Success Criteria (12-Month View)

At 12 months post-launch, Implementation Pro is successful if:

- 300+ paying customers across Pro and Team tiers
- \$20,000+ MRR with a clear path to \$50K
- < 4% monthly churn — users who pay, stay
- AI agent adoption > 60% among paid users — the AI value prop is proven
- Gumroad fully sunset — all former subscribers migrated or expired
- Category recognition — "Implementation Management" appears in at least 3 analyst reports or major publications

■ **Content moat** — top 3 Google results for "SaaS implementation management" and related keywords

<i>This is a living document. Revisited monthly as market feedback comes in and metrics are tracked.</i>